

The first sequel ever made was 1916's "Fall of a Nation," a follow-up to D.W. Griffith's wildly successful 1915 feature *Birth of a Nation*

Scarlett Johansson and Mickey Rourke have become confirmed participants in *Iron Man 2*

26

The total number of movies based on Marvel Comics

Sherlock Holmes

Don't worry, this is very much unlike the *History Channel* movies that you might've seen. Not to say that those are bad; this however is *rather* different. Guy Ritchie's own take on the classic, sees Robert Downey Jr. as the sword-slashing Holmes and Jude Law as a tough, no-nonsense Watson.

Strangely, it is based on a lesser known comic book by Lionel Wigram featuring the super-sleuth rather than directly upon Arthur Conan Doyle's books.

Guy Ritchie, who is highly acclaimed for movies such as *Snatch* and *Lock Stock...*, has had a life-long fascination for Sherlock Holmes' character. But will it be an action or suspense movie? We'll have to wait until the end of the year to find out. An added bonus that must be mentioned is Rachel McAdams as Irene Adler, a rather, ahem, infamous character from the original books.

Public Enemies

From the director of *Heat* and *Miami Vice* comes an old school Cop vs. Crook thriller that tells the true story of a Depression-era bank robber, played by none other than Johnny Depp, and the FBI agent named to capture him — Christian Bale. The charismatic bank robber was famous for his lightning raids and was somewhat of a local hero for the downtrodden of that era. Much of the public's angst was directed at the banks themselves since they had plunged the country into depression. Perfect timing for such a movie right? The film is also somewhat historical with relation to the formation of the FBI.

Going by the kind of testosterone action thriller that was *Heat* (maybe not *Miami Vice*), this should definitely turn out to be one of the year's biggest movies. The slick trailer at least shows that the film looks way flashier than it actually might be, thanks to the super-star cast. Keep a lookout for this one sometime in July.

Transformers 2: Revenge of the Fallen

The first *Transformers* seemed a tad juvenile, but then who are we kidding; robots that defy all known laws of physics and fold into neat little packages the size of matchboxes? It's gotta be taken with a pinch of salt. Even if the yellow robot can't talk and is much like a pet dog, the film was very visually appealing. The cascading sheets of metal combined with 80s metal, gave many a geek multiple joygasms. Let's hope this installment of the movie can live up to its predecessor and the hype. Reports suggest that it surely will. With around US \$200 million being spent on the production and a number of the scenes being filmed using IMAX cameras, the visual appeal will definitely be high. The film is also being shot all around the world including Egypt. Just imagine giant robots on the pyramids. Wow! *Revenge of the Fallen* follows Optimus Prime and his fellow Autobots (the good robots) as they attempt to rescue a kidnapped Sam Witwicky (Shia LaBeouf) from the villainous Decepticons. As for the cast you have all the guys from the first movie, but what we hope to see is more action, and certainly more of the ultra-curvey Megan Fox!

S. Darko

This was somewhat of a pleasant surprise, since the original *Donnie Darko* is now considered by many to be the quintessential thinking movie, with its time loop plot and blurred fantasy. What comes to mind however is the fate suffered by *Butterfly Effect 2*. Yes, it fell flat compared to the original. Being die hard fans of *Donnie Darko* we obviously think a sequel is superfluous, but at the same time hope that it does well and more importantly does justice to the original. The film picks up seven years after the original film. It follows Donnie Darko's younger sister, Samantha (Daveigh Chase), who has found herself at age 17 with a broken family, mired in feelings of insignificance. That's all we'll tell you about the plot, lest we spoil it.

X-Men Origins: Wolverine

Just the larger-than-life character of Wolverine is enough to pull crowds and interest in the movie. And to think that a whole film is dedicated to him is even better. We find Logan (played by Hugh Jackman) at a point 17 years before the first movie. The prospect of viewers getting to see how Logan became Wolverine, how he acquired his deadly claws, and cameos by future X-Men, will surely set internet discussion forums buzzing before the release. In fact, a teaser shows a boy (presumably Logan) drawing claws and mutilating a man against a wall. There is also the appearance of another favourite — Gambit. In some circles he is such a favourite that this might just become a curious case witnessed in *The Dark Knight*, with the Joker's persona overshadowing the lead — Batman.

Avatar

Directed by James Cameron and starring Sigourney Weaver; no it's not an *Alien* sequel. But since so little is known about the movie we can't say for sure. What we can say however is that Cameron will bring this movie to life using the very best of cutting edge technology. One example is that they are shooting this thing with 197 cameras simultaneously! Going by his selective filmography, we're sure to have some ground-breaking, breath-taking visual effects, much like we saw in *Terminator 2*. The plot too is uncommon. It is believed that humans are the invaders in the movie. Yup we're the little green men trying to take over someone's planet. As long as it has enough to appeal to the mainstream audience, it could well be one of the biggest movies of the year. Still, since it's slated with a year-end release you'll have to wait a pretty long while for this one.